Lesson 5: Clear Speaking

Module 2 | 45 minutes | Sounds, stress, pauses | Grades 3–6 · ages 8–11

Objective: Say tricky sounds clearly (v and w, th, and -ed endings), use stress and pauses, and read a short paragraph aloud.

Success criteria

- I can say v and w clearly.
- I can make the th sound with my tongue.
- I can say -ed endings as t, d or id.
- I can pause at commas and full stops when I read aloud.

Key vocabulary

- **sound**: The noise a letter or letters make when we say them.
- **tongue twister**: A silly sentence with similar sounds that is hard to say fast.
- **stress**: Saying a word a little louder and longer because it is important.
- **pause**: A short stop to take a breath.
- **ending**: The last part of a word, like -ed.

You will need

- Projector or screen share with Kitabash (lesson video, activities)
- Devices: 1 per learner (laptop, tablet or phone); a microphone helps for speaking tasks
- Printed worksheet, paper and pencil
- Project files: l05-practice-sheet-clear-speaking.md, l05-teacher-script.md

Timed lesson plan (45 min)

Time	Stage	What happens
5 min	**Warm-up game**	Mouth gym (copy the big mouth moves), then the whisper-chain tongue twister.
5 min	**Watch + show me**	Play the video. Then “v or w?”: teacher says words, learners show finger letters.
5 min	**Close-up demo**	Teacher camera close-up for v, w and th; tap the beats for walked, played, wanted.
6 min	**Build-along**	Tongue-twister training steps on the practice sheet; learners mark pauses in the paragraph.
7 min	**Game time**	v/w sort, the -ed sort as a race, then Find the pause (poll).
8 min	**Tongue-twister challenge**	Every learner tries the twister: slow, then fast. The class awards a “Clear Champion” badge for the clearest (not fastest) speaker.

6 min	**Show-and-tell: newsreaders**	Learners read the Wednesday paragraph like newsreaders; peers listen for pauses and give a thumbs up for each clear v and w.
3 min	**Probe + exit ticket**	New word: decided (poll), then the exit ticket in the chat.

Unplugged warm-up

Mouth gym and whisper chain (5 min): first copy the teacher's big mouth moves — lips round (w), teeth on lip (v), tongue out (th). Then play whisper chain: a twister is whispered from learner to learner in the order the teacher calls; the last learner says it aloud. Did it survive?

Teaching the idea

This lesson targets sounds that many Indian learners of English find tricky: v and w (often mixed), th (often said as t or d), and the three sounds of -ed. Make it physical and fun — mirrors, cameras, exaggerated mouths. Stress that Indian English is a real, respected English; the goal is to be clear, not to copy a foreign accent. Then teach pausing at punctuation and stressing important words, and finish with a tongue-twister challenge and a paragraph read-aloud.

Analogy: Your mouth is like a sports team: the lips, teeth and tongue each have a job, and today we train them like players at practice.

Live demo: 1) Turn on your camera close-up. Say van slowly, pointing to your teeth on your lip; say wet, pointing to your round lips. 2) Play "v or w?": say a word, learners show a V with fingers or a W with three fingers. 3) Show th with your tongue peeping out: think, three, this. 4) Say walked, played, wanted and tap the table once for each beat — wanted gets two taps. 5) Read the Wednesday paragraph twice: once with no pauses (rushed), once with pauses. Ask which was easier to understand.

Questions to ask

Ask	Listen for
Where do your teeth go for the v sound?	Top teeth gently on the bottom lip.
How do your lips look for w?	Round like an O, then they open.
Where does your tongue go for th?	Lightly between your teeth.
Which -ed word has an extra beat: jumped, played or painted?	Painted.
What do we do at a comma?	Take a short pause.

Differentiation

Support
Focus on one sound only (v/w) and use picture cards (van, window). Let learners say the twister in two halves.

Stretch
Write your own tongue twister with v and w words and challenge the class. Read the paragraph stressing different words and notice how the meaning changes.

Common misconceptions

Misconception	How to fix it
Saying “wery” for very or “vater” for water	Mirror check: teeth on lip for v; round lips with no teeth for w.
Saying “tree” for three or “dis” for this	Let your tongue peep between your teeth and blow air.
Saying every -ed with an extra beat: “jump-ed”	Only words ending in t or d sounds get the extra beat: want-ed, need-ed.
Thinking a good speaker must talk fast	Clear and steady is better. Pauses help people understand.

Assessment

Use the Code Lab results (auto-checked), the quick checks and the Probe answers. Written answers arrive in your review queue.

Exit ticket
Write one word with v and one word with w, and say them both aloud to yourself.

Homework
Teach your family the tongue twister and have a “clear, not fast” challenge. Read the Wednesday paragraph to someone with pauses.

Answer key — Kitabash activities

1. V sound or W sound at the start? (perform · categorize)

v (teeth on lip): van, vegetable, very, violin
w (round lips): window, water, wall, Wednesday

2. How does the -ed ending sound? (perform · categorize)

t (walked): jumped, washed, cooked
d (played): cleaned, opened, rained
id (wanted): painted, needed, shouted

3. Find the pause (perform · multiple choice)

Answer: After “school”, at the comma

4. Speak: tongue-twister challenge (perform · speaking)

Listen for: My teeth touched my lip for v · My lips were round for w · My tongue peeped out for th · I said it slowly and clearly first · I tried it faster without crashing

5. New word: decided (probe · multiple choice)

Answer: With an extra beat: de-ci-did

6. Probe: read a paragraph aloud (probe · speaking)

Listen for: I paused at every comma and full stop · I said v and w clearly (Wednesday, vegetable, very, watermelons) · I stressed important words · I read at a steady speed · I looked up at the end

Answer key — worksheet

1. **Key words:** sound = The noise a letter or letters make when we say them. · tongue twister = A silly sentence with similar sounds that is hard to say fast. · stress = Saying a word a little louder and longer because it is important. · pause = A short stop to take a breath.
2. **V sound or W sound at the start?:** v (teeth on lip): van, vegetable, very, violin · w (round lips): window, water, wall, Wednesday
3. **How does the -ed ending sound?:** t (walked): jumped, washed, cooked · d (played): cleaned, opened, rained · id (wanted): painted, needed, shouted
4. **Find the pause:** A. After “school”, at the comma — A comma is a signal to pause for a moment. Pausing there makes the sentence easy to follow.
5. **New word: decided:** C. With an extra beat: de-ci-did — Decide ends with a d sound, so -ed adds an extra beat: de-ci-did, like wanted and needed.

Kitabash original curriculum.